

INDIA'S GAMING BOOM

India's gaming population expanded to 488 million active online gamers in 2024, up 7 percent year-on-year, driven by affordable smartphones and data plans. The Indian gaming market was valued at USD 4.3 billion in 2024 and is projected to reach USD 5.83 billion by 2025, with a CAGR of 16.2 percent through 2034. Mobile gaming dominates, comprising 75 percent of India's total gaming revenue, with genres like battle royale and casual board games leading engagement.

On the policy front, the government's WAVES 2025 initiative under the Ministry of Information & Broadcasting supports the AVGC-XR (Animation, Visual Effects, Gaming, Comics & Extended Reality) sector with funding, incubation, and skill development, aiming to position India as a global hub. The Karnataka Online Gaming and Betting Regulatory Authority Bill, 2025 proposes clear licensing and regulation for skill-based gaming, distinguishing it from gambling to ensure safe, legal operations within the state.

Investment is soaring: Nazara Technologies reported a ₹1,363 cr gross gaming revenue for FY25 – a 60 percent increase – highlighting robust growth and investor confidence in domestic studios. Industry bodies like FICCI & EY forecast continued expansion, noting that India's market will soon rival Southeast Asia as Asia's second-largest gaming economy.

Demographically, 86 percent of Indian gamers are male, with 77 percent aged 18–34, indicating a young, tech-savvy audience ripe for innovative titles and esports development. With esports officially recognized as a sport and platforms like GEPL powering digital cricket leagues, India's competitive gaming scene is professionalizing rapidly.

Together, these trends underscore a vibrant, well-supported gaming ecosystem – fueling both consumer demand and homegrown development for the next decade.

- **Lakshya's Coloring Games (Emerging):** An indie app focusing on Indian motifs – Madhubani, Warli, Gond. Users choose templates, fill regions with color palettes, and share finished art on social feeds.

These easy-to-learn titles offer quick entertainment bursts, ideal for commuting or short breaks.

5. Safe Gaming Best Practices

Encouraging healthy, secure gaming ensures positive experiences for all ages. Follow these guidelines:

1. Set Time Limits

- **Android:** Use Digital Wellbeing → Dashboard to set daily timers for each game.
- **iOS:** Under Settings → Screen Time, configure App Limits for gaming apps.

2. Enable Privacy Controls

- Disable Voice Chat or restrict it to friends only in multiplayer titles like Ludo King and FAU-G.
- Turn off location sharing in game settings unless explicitly needed for gameplay.

3. Manage In-Game Purchases

- Require password/PIN for purchases:
 - **Android:** Open Play Store → Settings → Authentication for purchases → For all purchases.

- **iOS:** Settings → Content & Privacy Restrictions → iTunes & App Store Purchases → Require Password.

4. Use Official Sources

- Only download games from official Google Play, App Store, or Steam to prevent malware-infected piracy cracks.
- Check developer credentials – e.g., Nautilus Mobile, Gametion, Studio Sirah, Nodding Heads Games – before installing.

5. Protect Personal Data

- Avoid granting unnecessary permissions (contacts, SMS) unless core to gameplay.
- Review privacy policies – ensure data is not shared with third parties.

6. Encourage Family Play

- Many games (Ludo King, Carrom Pool) support local multiplayer or invite-only rooms – ideal for family bonding without strangers.
- Explore parchment-free board games like Ludo online, reducing physical clutter.

By combining cultural flair with robust mechanics, Indian developers have delivered a gaming renaissance that rivals global fare. These guidelines empower players to dive in safely, ensuring that the next generation of Indian gaming talent can shine on both local and international stages. 